

doc-god-existence

Affirms · Theology Proper › Existence · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

The one true and living God exists eternally as the self-existent creator and sustainer of all things.

Rationale

Scripture never argues for God's existence; it presupposes it from the first clause (Gen 1:1, Elohim H430 as subject of bara H1254) and treats denial as moral folly (Ps 14:1, nabal H5036). Heb 11:6 (G4100 pisteusai + G1510 estin) makes belief that God IS the entailment of any approach to him, and Rom 1:19-20 (G126 aidios, G2305 theiotes) grounds general revelation as universally accessible.

Reasoning

The Bible does not try to prove that God exists. It assumes it from the first sentence. Genesis 1:1 opens with God already there, creating the heavens and the earth. Psalm 14:1 says the person who claims there is no God is a fool, treating atheism as a moral problem rather than an intellectual one. Hebrews 11:6 puts it most plainly: anyone who wants to come to God has to believe that he is. Romans 1:19-20 says God's power and divine nature are clearly seen in what he has made, so that everyone is without excuse. The strongest tension comes from honest sufferers in Scripture. Habakkuk, Job, the psalmist of Psalm 73, and the psalmist of Psalm 88 all push hard against God's silence, but none of them stop believing he is there. Their complaints only make sense if they think someone is listening. So the Bible knows the experience of doubt and pain, but it never grants the conclusion that no God exists. That conclusion stays the position of the fool in its own categories.

Denominational landscape

Every historic Christian lineage affirms that the one true God exists. Catholic teaching states God is unique and there is only one God who made heaven and earth. Lutheran and Anglican confessions open with the same line: there is one living and true God, everlasting, of infinite power, wisdom, and goodness, maker and preserver of all things. Methodist Articles of Religion repeat that statement word for word. Eastern Orthodox doctrine begins with the Father almighty, maker of heaven and earth. Reformed confessions agree. Pentecostal and Anabaptist confessions also agree. Patristic and scholastic writers like Athanasius, Augustine, and Thomas Aquinas all defended God's existence by argument as well as by revelation. The categorical denial of God's existence is atheism, which lies outside every tracked Christian lineage. Public-record movements that deny the biblical God in other ways (Mormonism, Jehovah's Witnesses, Iglesia ni Cristo, Christian Science, Unitarian Universalists) still affirm some deity exists; their disputes belong to other doctrines and are not in view here.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	Yes
Would visit if otherwise	No

Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

Atheism (denial of any deity) and certain forms of practical atheism are the categorical denial in view. Public-record carriers of categorical theistic denial are organized atheist or naturalist movements; no historic Christian lineage denies God's existence. Unitarianism, JW's, and Mormonism all affirm a deity but deny other doctrines (Trinity, monotheism, etc.) and are handled by separate questions. Distinction between affirming God exists versus affirming the biblical God is preserved in adjacent doctrine questions; this question is the most basic theistic floor.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked

Grammatico-historical reading is sufficient. No framework (covenant, dispensational, new-covenant, progressive-covenantalism) produces a different verdict on whether God exists. The doctrine sits prior to every interpretive framework rather than being produced by one. Analogy of Scripture is invoked because the verdict rests on a pan-canonical pattern (Genesis through Hebrews) rather than a single passage. Progressive revelation is not load-bearing; theism is uniform from page one.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Gen.1.1 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key term. אֱלֹהִים elohim H430; בָּרָא bara H1254

Force. Scripture's opening clause has God as the grammatical subject of the verb create. Existence is presupposed, not argued.

Ps.14.1 · **for** · genre: psalm

Key term. נָבִיל nabal H5036; אֵין ein H369; אֱלֹהִים elohim H430

Force. The fool (moral, not intellectual category) says in his heart there is no God. Atheism is classified as folly, not as a defensible intellectual stance.

Ps.53.1 · **for** · genre: psalm

Key term. נָבִיל nabal H5036; אֵין ein H369; אֱלֹהִים elohim H430

Force. Duplicate of Ps 14:1 with minor variation. Establishes the verdict as a recurring canonical refrain, not a one-off line.

Heb.11.6 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key term. πιστεῦσαι pisteusai G4100; ἔστιν estin G1510; θεός theos G2316; προσερχόμενον proserchomenon G4334

Force. Anyone who would draw near to God must believe that he IS. The verb of being makes God's existence the entry condition of all approach to him.

Rom.1.19-20 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key term. αἰδιος aidios G126; δύναμις dynamis G1411; θειότης theiotes G2305; ἀναπολόγητος anapologetos G379

Force. God's eternal power and divine nature are clearly seen in what has been made, leaving humanity without defense. General revelation grounds universal accessibility of the conclusion that God is.

Acts.17.24-28 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key term. θεός theos G2316; ποιήσας poiesas G4160; κόσμος kosmos G2889

Force. Paul in Athens addresses pagans without first proving God exists; he assumes a creator who made the world and in whom we live and move and have our being.

Exod.3.14 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key term. הָיָה אֲשֶׁר הָיָה ehyeh asher ehyeh H1961

Force. God's self-disclosure as I AM ties the divine name to the verb of being itself. Existence is intrinsic to God's name and identity.

Ps.19.1 · **for** · genre: psalm

Key term. אֵל el H410; כָּבוֹד kavod H3519

Force. The heavens declare the glory of God and the firmament shows his handiwork. Creation itself functions as ongoing testimony to God's existence.

Hab.1.2 · **complicates** · genre: prophecy

Key term. יהוה YHWH H3068

Force. Habakkuk's theodicy complaint is directed AT God by name. Even the sharpest protest against divine silence in Scripture presupposes that God is there to hear it.

Job.13.15 · **complicates** · genre: wisdom

Key term. יהוה YHWH H3068

Force. Job's though he slay me yet will I trust him is the canonical floor of theodicy: God's existence is never the variable. Job contests God's justice while assuming his being.

Ps.73.1-17 · **complicates** · genre: psalm

Key term. אֱלֹהִים elohim H430

Force. The psalmist nearly slips at the apparent injustice of God's providence but recovers in the sanctuary. Doubt about God's fairness, never doubt about his existence, is the canonical pattern.

Ps.88.1-18 · **complicates** · genre: psalm

Key term. יהוה YHWH H3068

Force. The bleakest lament psalm; ends without resolution. Yet the entire complaint is addressed to YHWH by name. Scripture's deepest darkness still assumes a divine hearer.

Concordance lemmas traversed

H430, H3068, H410, H1254, H5036, H369, H1961, H3519, G2316, G4100, G1510, G4334, G126, G1411, G2305, G379, G4160, G2889

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church, paragraphs 200 and 212 · affirms · verified

“God is unique; there is only one God. He transcends the world and history. He made heaven and earth.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession, Article I, Of God · affirms · verified

“There is one Divine Essence which is called and which is God: eternal, without body, without parts, of infinite power, wisdom, and goodness.”

anglican · Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion, Article I, Of Faith in the Holy Trinity · affirms · verified

“There is but one living and true God, everlasting, of infinite power, wisdom, and goodness; the Maker, and Preserver of all things visible and invisible.”

methodist · Methodist Articles of Religion, Article I, Of Faith in the Holy Trinity · affirms · verified

“There is but one living and true God, everlasting, without body or parts, of infinite power, wisdom, and goodness; the maker and preserver of all things.”

patristic · Thomas Aquinas, Summa Theologica I, Q.2, A.3 (the Five Ways, scholastic but received as the patristic-scholastic synthesis) · affirms · verified

“Therefore it is necessary to arrive at a first mover, put in motion by no other; and this everyone understands to be God.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox Church in America, Doctrine of the Symbol of Faith (Nicene Creed), I believe in one God the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth · affirms · unverified

“I believe in one God, the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, and of all things visible and invisible.”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith, Chapter 2, paragraph 1 · affirms · unverified

“There is but one only, living, and true God, who is infinite in being and perfection, a most pure spirit, invisible, without body, parts, or passions.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/genesis/1-1.htm>

“Genesis 1:1: bereshit bara elohim, In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth. Elohim H430 as subject of bara H1254; existence is presupposed.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/psalms/14-1.htm>

“Psalm 14:1: The fool (nabal H5036) has said in his heart, there is no God (ein elohim, H369 H430). Atheism is classified as moral folly.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/hebrews/11-6.htm>

“Heb 11:6: He that comes to God must believe that he IS (estin G1510). Belief in God's existence is the entry condition of approach.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/1-20.htm>

“Rom 1:20: God's eternal power (aidios dynamis, G126 G1411) and divine nature (theiotes G2305) clearly seen, leaving humanity without defense (anapologetos G379).”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/exodus/3-14.htm>

“Exod 3:14: ehyeh asher ehyeh, I AM that I AM (hayah H1961). The divine name ties God's identity to the verb of being itself.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/hebrew/430.htm>

“Strong's H430 elohim: 2598 OT occurrences. Standard term for the one true God of Israel, also for gods/judges; canonical density is overwhelming.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/hebrew/3068.htm>

“Strong's H3068 YHWH: about 6220 OT occurrences. The proper name of the God of Israel, connected to the verb of being. Self-existence intrinsic to name.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/2316.htm>

“Strong's G2316 theos: 1327 NT occurrences. The supreme Divinity, creator and owner of all things, sustainer of all.”

supports · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/___P16.HTM

“CCC 200, 212: God is unique; there is only one God. He transcends the world and history. He made heaven and earth.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/of-god/>

“Augsburg I: There is one Divine Essence which is called and which is God: eternal, without body, without parts, of infinite power, wisdom, and goodness.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“Methodist Article I: There is but one living and true God, everlasting, of infinite power, wisdom, and goodness; the maker and preserver of all things.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · https://anglicansonline.org/basics/thirty-nine_articles.html

“Anglican Article I: There is but one living and true God, everlasting, of infinite power, wisdom, and goodness; the Maker and Preserver of all things visible and invisible.”

supports · category: patristic_archive · https://ccel.org/ccel/aquinas/summa/summa.FP_Q2_A3.html

“Aquinas Five Ways: Therefore it is necessary to arrive at a first mover, put in motion by no other; and this everyone understands to be God.”

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